

GIDA Selected to Support the Design of Gender-Disaggregated Data for Impact Sprint

Lagos, Nigeria — September 2026

Growth Innovation for Development Action (GIDA) continues to expand its footprint in Nigeria's financial inclusion landscape, having been selected to participate in the prestigious Alliance for Innovative Regulation (AIR) and Central Bank of Nigeria (CBN) Activating Gender-Disaggregated Data for Impact Design Sprint. GIDA's engagement is already underway, opening with a virtual bootcamp on September 15 and continuing into an in-person design sprint September 22–24 in Lagos State. The selection marks another milestone in GIDA's growing track record as a trusted technical partner to regulators and financial institutions and reaffirms our expanding role in converting granular, gender-disaggregated data into actionable financial innovation and inclusive policy design.



Rethinking Agribusiness **Partnership Models for Women**



PAYO & BNPL: FINANCING WOMEN CAN USE

AIR x CBN Gender-Disaggregated Data Sprint | Lagos, Sept 22–24

This achievement builds on GIDA's accelerating momentum across Nigeria's inclusive finance ecosystem. As our portfolio of market systems and rural livelihoods work matures, opportunities like this sprint validate a model we have been scaling deliberately: pairing ground-level insight from women micro-entrepreneurs, smallholder farmers, and informal traders with the technical rigor regulators and financial service providers need to act on it.

Traditional credit architectures frequently fail to capture the economic reliability of these groups. Through this design sprint, GIDA is advancing alternative credit-scoring frameworks that power tailored Pay-As-You-Own (PAYO) and Buy Now, Pay Later (BNPL) financial models. Replacing rigid collateral demands with alternative metrics such as community savings consistency, harvest-aligned cash flows, and group equity for unlocking access to productive assets at a scale traditional finance has struggled to reach.

From Inclusion to Impact

For GIDA, this sprint is about progressing from inclusion to producing real impact. Gender-Disaggregated Data (GDD) is not an end. Its purpose is to expand finance for women-owned businesses in ways that change how rural actors interact with the formal financial system itself.

An account opened is not the same as financial access, and financial access is not the same as financial health. The real question the sprint must answer is whether a woman farmer or trader is able to save enough, accumulate resources, and build a financial cushion, not merely whether her name is on a bank record. An account that is opened but never funded does not advance social dignity; it simply relocates exclusion into a new column of the same spreadsheet.

True financial inclusion does not end at account opening. It is dignity in ownership, in use, and in accumulated resources over time. That is the shift GIDA is pushing this sprint to make: from awareness of financial products to actual enrolment, and from enrolment to sustained, trusted use because inclusion that stops at signature is not inclusion at all.

What Changes Because of the Sprint

GIDA is bringing a clear point of view into the design room;

- what incentivizes lasting behaviour change and trust matters as much as what product is on offer.
- Weakened savings capacity raises the cost of credit and the cost of essential inputs precisely for the households that can least absorb it.

Which is why economic empowerment will no longer be treated as an add-on to financial inclusion. It is foundational to building resilient ecosystems and rural livelihoods in the first place. There will be more focus on distinguishing financial distress from financial health and designing accordingly. Promoting GIDA's approach that discourages credit used purely for consumption (which leaves repayment fragile) in favour of credit paired with financial literacy training, documentation and real access to productive, working assets.

The goal is credit that rural actors in the green economy, especially women and youth, can actually afford, and that is in sync with how they earn and what they already trust: community savings groups, harvest cycles, and group equity, rather than instruments imposed from outside that logic.

GIDA also sees a role for industry in this shift. Private-sector actors, anchor firms, off-takers, and financial service providers alike championing financial inclusion and financial health as part of how they do business, not as a separate corporate responsibility line item. And within the sprint, GIDA is pressing a deliberate methodology: move from evidence through data, to experimentation, to scale. Discarding what fails quickly and scaling what works, rather than defending a fixed design against the evidence.

Designing for What Rural Actors Actually Trust

A central design question GIDA is bringing to the sprint is simple to state and hard to answer well. *Who needs credit? What are they borrowing for? And why do they trust the savings organizations and groups they already belong to?* Those answers, not assumptions imported from urban or formal-sector lending should shape how gender-disaggregated data gets used. GIDA is also exploring how savings products, pension products, and health coverage (HMO) can be built directly into BNPL and PAYO models, so that access to credit today does not come at the expense of resilience tomorrow.

Building from the Grassroots and Scaling Upward

GIDA's participation reflects a broader growth trajectory. Turning grassroots data into systems-level impact across three pillars building sustained momentum in our portfolio:

- **Improved Agricultural Systems** - De-risking financing for climate-resilient inputs, modern processing machinery, and storage infrastructure for women-led agricultural enterprises, expanding what's investable at the last mile.
- **Essential Health & Well-being** - Designing flexible PAYO & BNPL models that improve household access to clean energy, clean water, and essential healthcare services without crippling upfront costs.
- **Sustainable Livelihoods** - Equipping informal market traders and small business owners with predictable working capital to scale operations, build economic resilience, and achieve long-term autonomy.

As GIDA collaborates alongside regulatory bodies, financial service providers, and technology innovators throughout the sprint, this engagement adds to a growing body of evidence that gender-disaggregated data is not just a reporting metric. It is a tool for transformative, grassroots impact, and a signal of the scale GIDA is positioned to operate at across Nigeria and beyond.